

PROGRAM OVERVIEW

Program Guide

A student-centered financial literacy curriculum for Grades 7–12.

WISE equips students with real-world money skills, practical tools, and the confidence to make informed decisions about their futures. Through engaging, age-appropriate learning experiences, students learn how to earn, manage, save, invest, and plan for their goals — skills that create greater opportunities today and brighter futures tomorrow.

Designed for schools and community programs, WISE is flexible, culturally responsive, and easy to implement in a variety of settings, including classrooms, after-school programs, advisory or homeroom, and community-based programs. Whether you're a district leader, school administrator, or community partner, WISE provides the curriculum, resources, and support you need to bring high-quality financial literacy to more students.

***“Real-world money skills.
Stronger students.
Brighter futures.”***



Practical Skills

Built for real life.



Flexible Implementation

Works in schools and community programs.



Equitable Access

Every student. Every opportunity.



Lasting Impact

Stronger students. Stronger communities.

PROGRAM NARRATIVE

What Is WISE?

A student-centered financial literacy program that helps learners build practical money knowledge, make informed choices, and apply financial skills in real life.

WISE is a student-centered financial literacy program designed to give middle and high school learners the knowledge, skills, and confidence to make informed financial decisions. WISE stands for **Wealth · Income · Saving · Empowerment**, reflecting our belief that financial knowledge creates greater opportunities and brighter futures.

Through engaging, age-appropriate learning experiences, students build confidence with budgeting, planning, saving, and real-world money decisions. The program meets students where they are, providing practical tools and relatable examples that connect to their everyday lives and future goals.

WISE is designed for middle and high school learners and can be implemented in schools, after-school programs, advisory or homeroom settings, and community-based programs. Its flexible design makes it easy to adapt across different learning environments while maintaining a consistent, high-quality experience.

The curriculum includes three core instructional units plus a capstone experience, giving students a structured path from foundational concepts to real-world application. Throughout the program, students are encouraged to apply what they learn to authentic situations—helping them see the value of financial literacy today and into the future.

“Financial literacy becomes powerful when students can apply it to real decisions.”

WISE Means

Wealth · Income ·
Saving · Empowerment

3

CORE INSTRUCTIONAL UNITS

WISE at a Glance

-  3 core units + capstone
-  Student workbook + teacher supports
-  Digital tools and family connection materials
-  Flexible for schools and community programs

AT A GLANCE

Program at a Glance

WISE is designed as a three-Dimension, nine-Unit, 27-lesson financial-literacy program. This delivery package contains Dimension 1 — Foundation.

ITEM	WISE FLAGSHIP PROGRAM
Grade Band	Grades 7–12
Program Structure	3 Dimensions · 9 Units · 27 Lessons
Capstones	3 Dimension Capstones + 1 Final Program Capstone
Core Student Path	Student Workbook + lesson activities + assessments + capstones
Teacher Support	Lesson plans, activity guidance, slides, assessment/answer guidance, implementation resources
Family Support	English and Spanish family-facing materials aligned to units/capstones
Digital Learning	Access-flexible digital companions with a complete non-device pathway
Assessment	Pre/Post reflection, Exit Tickets, Unit Reviews, Unit Quizzes in Dimension 1, Dimension Checks, Capstones
Implementation	Classroom, advisory/homeroom, elective, after-school/community, summer, phased or dimension-based rollout

Who Is WISE For?

WISE is designed for districts and schools that want a coherent financial-literacy experience for students in Grades 7–12 and need flexibility in how the program is delivered. This package provides the complete **Dimension 1 — Foundation** stage.

FIT & SETTINGS

Best-Fit Settings & Grade-Band Pathways

SETTING	HOW WISE CAN BE USED
Financial-literacy course or semester elective	Teach Dimension 1 as a coherent 9-lesson sequence. Later Dimensions may be added separately if the school adopts them.
Advisory or homeroom	Divide lessons into shorter sessions and preserve the core learning flow.
After-school or youth program	Use the scenario-based lessons, activities, and capstones in a flexible schedule.
Summer or intensive program	Use a condensed pacing model while protecting the essential practice and capstone checkpoints.
Pilot or phased rollout	Begin with one unit, one three-unit stage, or a selected grade band before broader implementation.
Community-connected program	Pair lessons with approved community speakers or family-engagement activities without replacing classroom instruction.

Grades 7–8

Concrete scenarios, rounded numbers, vocabulary support, visual organizers, modeled examples, shorter decision sets, and alternate response modes.

Grades 9–12

More complex comparisons, longer-term planning, independent reasoning, and extensions connected to work, credit, investing, protection, and policy.

Who Uses Which Materials

District and school leaders use the overview, standards, scope, pacing, onboarding, readiness, technology, accessibility, assessment, and family-engagement resources.

Teachers and facilitators use the lesson plans, Student Workbook, activities, slides, assessments, answer guidance, capstones, and training materials.

Students use the Student Workbook, student handouts, capstone files, assigned family materials, and optional digital companions.

Families and caregivers use the English or Spanish family materials and conversation guides.

LEARNING JOURNEY

The WISE Learning Journey

WISE progresses through three stages of financial capability, helping students build knowledge, develop skills, and apply learning to real-life decisions.



PROGRAM MAP

The 27-Lesson Program Map

Three Dimensions, nine Units, twenty-seven lessons. This delivery package contains Dimension 1 — Foundation, highlighted below.

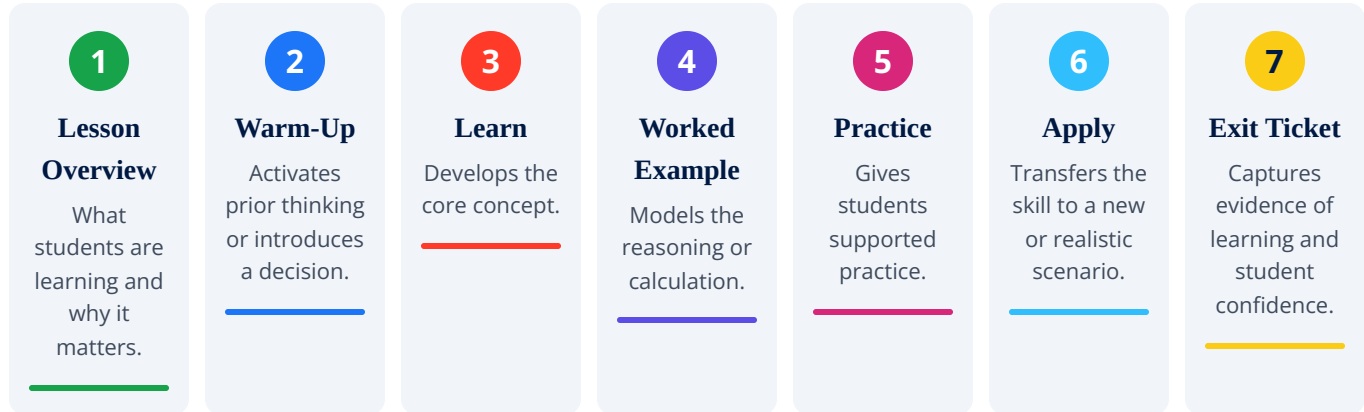
DIMENSION	UNIT	LESSONS
Foundation (this package)	Unit 1 Budgeting & Planning	1.1 Introduction to Budgeting · 1.2 Needs vs. Wants · 1.3 Building a Savings Habit
	Unit 2 Money Mindset & Values	2.1 Understanding Money Mindsets · 2.2 Culture, Community & Family · 2.3 Financial Values & Goal Setting
	Unit 3 Saving, Interest & Inflation	3.1 Emergency Savings & Financial Resilience · 3.2 Understanding Interest · 3.3 Inflation & Purchasing Power
Money Moves	Unit 4 Banking & Financial Institutions	4.1 Choosing a Financial Institution · 4.2 Checking & Savings Accounts · 4.3 Opening and Managing an Account
	Unit 5 Credit & Debt Management	5.1 What Is Credit? · 5.2 The True Cost of Credit · 5.3 Managing Debt
	Unit 6 Earning & Income	6.1 Types of Income · 6.2 Reading a Paycheck · 6.3 Growing Your Income
Building Wealth	Unit 7 Investing & Wealth Building	7.1 Why Investing Matters · 7.2 Investment Choices · 7.3 Starting Early & Compound Growth
	Unit 8 Insurance & Risk Management	8.1 Understanding Insurance · 8.2 Matching Coverage to Risk · 8.3 Emergency Funds & Resilience
	Unit 9 Consumer Protection & Fraud	9.1 Spotting Scams · 9.2 Consumer Rights & Protection · 9.3 Identity Theft Defense

About the larger WISE program: WISE is designed as a larger three-Dimension financial-literacy program. This delivery package contains **Dimension 1 — Foundation** only. No Dimension 2 or Dimension 3 materials are required to implement Dimension 1 successfully.

INSTRUCTIONAL MODEL

Consistent Lesson Architecture

WISE lessons use a predictable instructional rhythm so students spend less time figuring out the format and more time learning the financial skill.



Some lessons also include reflection, research, additional practice, activities, or digital companions when they support the learning outcome. Digital access never replaces the core workbook path.

ADDITIONAL LEARNING SUPPORTS

- Reflection** — deeper thinking about what's been learned.
- Research** — guided exploration of real-world topics.
- Additional Practice** — extra reps when it supports mastery.
- Activities** — engaging tasks that deepen connections.
- Digital Companions** — optional tools and simulations.

ACROSS-THE-UNIT SUPPORTS

- Unit Reviews and Bridges** — connect learning and preview what's next.
- Unit Quizzes** — formal unit-level checkpoints.
- Dimension Capstones** — apply and synthesize learning across a dimension.
- Final Program Capstone** — a culminating, program-wide demonstration.

DESIGN PRINCIPLES

Instructional Design Principles



Concept Before Procedure

Students understand why a financial idea matters before being asked to use a formula, process, or decision tool.



Skill-Forward Learning

Students calculate, compare, interpret, explain, decide, revise, and justify rather than only memorize vocabulary.



Spiral Learning

Important ideas return at increasing levels of complexity — from saving habit to emergency savings to financial resilience.



Whole-Person Financial Learning

Decisions are shaped by knowledge, beliefs, values, family and community experiences, access, opportunity, and risk.



Privacy-Safe Participation

Students are never required to disclose private household financial information to participate meaningfully.



Complete Non-Device Path

The lesson, workbook, activity, and assessment pathway remains complete without digital tools.



Flexible but Coherent

Schools can adapt pacing and delivery while preserving the instructional sequence and essential learning outcomes.

WHAT'S INSIDE

Student & Teacher Materials



Student Materials

The student learning system includes:

- the complete WISE Student Workbook
- lesson-aligned activity handouts
- Unit Reviews
- three formal Dimension 1 Unit Quizzes /20
- Exit Tickets
- three Dimension Capstones
- the Final Program Capstone
- planning and reference templates
- formula and calculation support
- English and Spanish reference vocabulary
- progress and reflection tools

The Student Workbook is the primary student learning path.



Teacher Materials

The flagship teacher package includes:

- lesson plans organized by Unit and Lesson
- Teacher Quick Start and implementation guidance
- Activity Book — Teacher Edition
- lesson slide sources and teacher reference materials
- assessment and answer-key guidance
- capstone rubrics and scoring support
- digital-tool teacher guidance
- grade-band adaptation guidance
- privacy and responsive-facilitation guidance
- pacing and implementation resources

Teacher materials make the instructional intent visible — not only what to teach, but how each lesson connects to the larger program.

PRACTICE & EVIDENCE

Activity System & Assessment Architecture

30

FULL ROADMAP ACTIVITIES

12

DIMENSION 1 ACTIVITIES

5

FORMAL /20 SCORES

The activity system includes lesson-aligned core or recommended activities, selected optional extensions, collaborative practice, decision-making tasks, research and comparison activities, scenario-based application, and student recording pages where needed. Activities support the lesson rather than replace the Student Workbook learning path.

WISE uses multiple forms of evidence rather than relying on one test.



Program-Level

Pre-Assessment and Post-Assessment separate confidence growth from demonstrated skill.



Lesson-Level

27 lesson Exit Tickets and formative checks within lessons.



Unit-Level

Unit Reviews and Vocabulary Reviews, plus one formal 20-point Unit Quiz per unit in Dimension 1.



Dimension-Level & Synthesis

Dimension Checks I–III, Capstones I–III, and the Final Program Capstone.

Open-response and financial-choice tasks are evaluated for accurate reasoning, relevant evidence, and recognition of trade-offs. Personal financial choices are not scored against one required lifestyle preference.

EXTENDING THE CLASSROOM

Digital Companions & Family Engagement



Digital Companions

WISE includes an expanded digital-tool ecosystem with **31 instructional or capstone tools plus the Interactive Learning Hub**. Digital tools may support lesson practice, comparison and calculation, decision-making, simulations, planning, capstone work, and navigation.

Digital companions are access-flexible. They do not replace or block the core curriculum path. Every lesson retains a meaningful non-device pathway so a lack of devices, live internet access, or approved hosting does not prevent students from reaching the essential learning outcome.

Dimension 1 includes 10 optional digital companions plus the Interactive Learning Hub. The complete core learning pathway can be taught without student devices.



Family Engagement

WISE includes family-facing materials in English and Spanish. The family system includes:

- a program overview for families
- unit-level family communications across the program
- family notes for staged Capstones as provided
- English and Spanish versions where available
- bilingual navigation support

Family materials support conversation without asking families to disclose private financial information or reteach the complete lesson at home. Family participation is supportive and optional.

GRADE BAND DEPTH

Grades 7–12: One Program, Two Depths

WISE is designed for a broad secondary grade band with two implementation pathways. The essential financial reasoning remains consistent across the grade band while depth and independence increase.

Grades 7–8

Teachers emphasize:

- concrete scenarios
- rounded or accessible numbers
- vocabulary support
- visual organizers
- modeled examples
- shorter decision sets
- structured partner discussion
- alternate response modes where appropriate

Grades 9–12

Teachers can increase:

- calculation complexity
- independent reasoning
- work and paycheck analysis
- credit and borrowing analysis
- long-term planning
- investing and risk comparisons
- policy or access context
- numeric justification

The essential financial reasoning remains consistent across the grade band while the depth and independence increase.

DELIVERY OPTIONS

Implementation Models

WISE can be implemented in multiple settings without changing the program's core architecture.



Full Program Roadmap

The complete WISE roadmap is designed for 27 lessons, three Dimension Capstones, and a Final Program Capstone. This delivery package covers Dimension 1 — Foundation.



Semester or Elective

Longer class periods allow deeper activity integration, digital companions, additional practice, and capstone development.



Advisory or Homeroom

Lessons divide into shorter sessions while preserving the Warm-Up → Learn → Worked Example → Practice → Apply → Exit Ticket sequence.



After-School or Community

Flexible session pacing combines relationship-building, core instruction, collaborative activities, and capstone work.



Summer or Intensive

Concentrated scheduling protects core practice and assessment checkpoints.



Dimension-Based or Phased Rollout

A school or district may implement Foundation, Money Moves, or Building Wealth as a coherent three-unit stage before expanding to the full program.

A condensed or partial implementation should be identified as such and should not be represented as equivalent to completion of the full 9-unit program.

DESIGNED FOR EVERY STUDENT

Privacy, Equity, and Accessibility

WISE is designed so students can participate without revealing private financial information.

Instruction should:

- | | |
|--|---|
|  Use fictional, sample, rounded, public, or teacher-provided information. |  Avoid requiring household income, debt, account information, credit scores, insurance details, identity data, or passwords. |
|  Allow students to generalize or use fictional examples for sensitive reflection. |  Treat differences in income, access, family structure, culture, and community resources without shame. |
|  Provide non-device learning paths and support multilingual learners. |  Allow multiple defensible financial choices when students can explain their reasoning. |

WISE treats financial literacy as a tool for agency and informed decision-making, not as a measure of character.

CROSSWALK

Standards Alignment

WISE includes a complete standards crosswalk for Grades 7–12.



The flagship standards system aligns the curriculum to current Illinois Social Science Financial Literacy expectations for Grades 6–8 and Grades 9–12, as applicable to the WISE grade band; the National Standards for Personal Financial Education; and supporting academic standards where the lesson directly teaches and assesses the related skill.

The separate **WISE Standards Alignment Master Crosswalk** is the authority for specific codes, lesson-level mappings, grade-band accommodations, and alignment cautions. Districts may add local or state-specific crosswalks during adoption.

What a District Receives

This WISE delivery package provides the complete **Dimension 1 — Foundation** stage, organized across program, teacher, student, family, data, and optional community resources.

PACKAGE CONTENTS

What a District Receives

	Program & District Resources Program Guide, Scope & Sequence, Pacing Guide, Standards Alignment, administrator/readiness/technology/accessibility resources, assessment & data guidance.		Teacher Resources Lesson plans for Units 1–3, Activity Book — Teacher Edition, Assessments & Answer Keys (three 20-point Unit Quizzes), slide source, PD resources, Assignment & Grade Tracker.
	Student Resources Dimension 1 Student Workbook, Student Activity Handouts, Capstone I — My Financial Future, optional digital companions.		Family Resources English family materials, Spanish family materials, launch/welcome communications.
	Data & Reporting Resources Assessment Implementation Walkthrough, Data & Reporting Toolkit, Data Tracker, Assignment & Grade Tracker, Program Summary Report Template, Teacher Dashboard specification.		Community & Showcase (Optional) Guest Speaker & Community Partner Guide, Capstone I Showcase Guide, Capstone I Showcase Invitation.

Program note: Dimensions 2 and 3, Capstones II and III, and the Final Program Capstone are part of the broader WISE architecture and are separate from this Dimension 1 package.

ONE INSTRUCTIONAL SYSTEM

How the Components Work Together

WISE is designed as one instructional system. No single component is the program by itself — the value comes from the alignment among them.

- 01 LESSON PLANS** guide instruction.
- 02 STUDENT WORKBOOK** provides the student learning path.
- 03 ACTIVITIES & HANDOUTS** add collaborative and applied practice.
- 04 SLIDES** provide visual instructional support.
- 05 ASSESSMENTS** provide evidence of learning.
- 06 CAPSTONES** connect skills across Units and Dimensions.
- 07 DIGITAL COMPANIONS** add access-flexible interactive practice when available.
- 08 FAMILY MATERIALS** extend understanding beyond the classroom.
- 09 IMPLEMENTATION GUIDES** support successful adoption and delivery.

WISE in Action

This example shows how the WISE components work together during one lesson. It is a sample of the instructional system, not a script that replaces the unit lesson plan.

Example: Lesson 1.1 — Introduction to Budgeting. Before class, the teacher opens the Unit 1 lesson plan, the matching Student Workbook section, the related Activity Book directions, and the Lesson 1.1 exit-ticket guidance, then chooses the core activity and prepares the sample scenario.

WISE IN ACTION

During Class: Lesson 1.1

- 01 WARM-UP** Students consider how a plan can help someone make choices with limited money.
- 02 LEARN** The teacher introduces the purpose of a budget using a fictional scenario.
- 03 WORKED EXAMPLE** The class calculates income, expenses, savings, and balance together.
- 04 PRACTICE** Students complete a guided budget calculation in the workbook.
- 05 ACTIVITY** Students apply the idea through a collaborative decision task or the non-device workbook path.
- 06 APPLY** Students create or analyze a sample spending plan without disclosing household information.
- 07 EXIT TICKET** Students show what they understand and identify any support they need.

THE COMPONENT CONNECTION

COMPONENT	ROLE IN THE LESSON
Lesson plan	Teacher language, timing, differentiation, privacy guidance, and lesson flow.
Student Workbook	Instruction, examples, practice, application, reflection, and exit ticket.
Activity Book	Teacher directions and debrief for collaborative practice.
Slide source	Optional visual support for pacing, prompts, and examples.
Digital companion	Optional interactive practice when the district chooses to use it.
Assessment & answer guidance	Evidence and feedback for the lesson objective.

WISE IN ACTION

Why the Model Works

The teacher can use the complete paper path, add a collaborative activity, project the slide source, use a digital companion, or combine those modes. The essential learning outcome remains intact across classroom conditions.

What a District Reviewer Can See

One lesson demonstrates the larger WISE design: consistent lesson flow; alignment between teaching, student work, activity, and assessment; a non-device path that is complete rather than an emergency substitute; privacy-safe fictional scenarios; grade-band accommodations; and a clear bridge from lesson learning to capstone work.

WISE Promise & District Value

Every lesson works on paper. Digital tools can deepen practice when a district has the devices and approval to use them.

WISE Financial Literacy helps students build practical financial reasoning, confidence, and agency through a complete learning journey—not a collection of disconnected worksheets or a digital tool that assumes every classroom has the same access.

DISTRICT VALUE

What Makes WISE Distinctive

- | | |
|--|---|
| <div data-bbox="129 430 779 598">  <p>Complete Core Path
Lesson plans, Student Workbook, activities, assessments, and capstones form a usable instructional sequence.</p> </div> | <div data-bbox="836 430 1485 598">  <p>Core + Offline Design
Students complete the program without devices; digital companions add practice rather than replace the curriculum.</p> </div> |
| <div data-bbox="129 661 779 829">  <p>Whole-Person Financial Learning
Students examine values, money messages, culture, community, access, and structural conditions alongside financial mechanics.</p> </div> | <div data-bbox="836 661 1485 829">  <p>Privacy-Safe Participation
Fictional, sample, rounded, and teacher-provided scenarios make meaningful learning possible without household disclosure.</p> </div> |
| <div data-bbox="129 924 779 1092">  <p>Skill-Forward Instruction
Students calculate, compare, explain, decide, communicate, and revise—not simply memorize vocabulary.</p> </div> | <div data-bbox="836 924 1485 1092">  <p>Capstone Coherence
Three staged capstones and a final synthesis project connect learning across the nine units.</p> </div> |
| <div data-bbox="129 1165 779 1327">  <p>Flexible Implementation
Districts can use WISE as a course, advisory sequence, enrichment program, summer program, pilot, or phased rollout.</p> </div> | <div data-bbox="836 1165 1485 1327">  <p>Family Connection
English and Spanish family materials help caregivers understand the learning and support conversation at home.</p> </div> |

A practical adoption question: WISE is a strong fit for a district that wants financial literacy to be teachable, adaptable, privacy-safe, standards-informed, and usable across different classroom realities. Begin with the Dimension 1 District & School Readiness Checklist, School Leader Overview, Pilot & Adoption Guide, and Standards Alignment.

PROGRAM SYNTHESIS

Full Program Completion Roadmap

Students who complete the full WISE sequence across all three Dimensions will have worked through:

3

DIMENSIONS

9

UNITS

27

LESSONS

3

DIMENSION CAPSTONES

1

FINAL PROGRAM CAPSTONE

They have practiced how to plan and adjust a budget; connect financial decisions to values and goals; save and reason about interest and inflation; navigate financial institutions and accounts; understand credit, borrowing cost, and debt strategies; interpret income and take-home pay; distinguish saving from investing and evaluate investment choices; use insurance and emergency savings to manage risk; and recognize fraud, use consumer protections, and respond to identity theft.

The program concludes by asking students to bring those skills together into one adaptable financial-life plan.